




> I have had the good fortune to come to the land of Mahatma Gandhi. WHO Centre in Jamnagar would make Gujarat a world leader in traditional medicine."
>
> — *Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus, Director-General of the World Health Organization*

System of Medicine (CIRISM), and Centre for PG Studies and Research in Ayurveda — were amalgamated to form the Institute for Ayurvedic Studies and Research (IASR). In 1967, the Gujarat Ayurveda University was established in Jamnagar and IASR was taken over by the university. The postgraduate centre became an integral part of the university and was renamed as Institute of Teaching and Research in Ayurveda (ITRA). It is the first Institute in Ayush Sector to have received the Institution of National Importance (INI) status.

### GUJARAT GOVERNMENT'S PUSH FOR AYUSH

In the past two decades, Government of Gujarat has been taking persistent steps for the promotion of Ayurvedic treatments and studies in the state. In 2021, around 27.05 lakh patients were treated at government Ayurvedic hospitals and clinics while 9.35 lakh patients were treated in government homoeopathic clinics, according to the Socio-Economic Review of 2021-22.

In the budget 2022-23, Gujarat announced a provision of Rs 12 crore for starting an Ayurveda College at Surendranagar. In addition, a provision of Rs 1 crore was also announced for construction of new buildings of Ayurveda at Bilimora of Navsari District.

The budget also allocated Rs 3 crore for organising 'AYUSH Diagnosis Treatment Camp' and 'AYUSH Mela', a new initiative. Also, the health budget under the head of major works related to buildings, has dedicated Rs 22 crore for construction of new centres for Ayurveda treatment against Rs 43.35 crore allocated for renovation and construction of buildings pertaining to allopathy institutes.

### HOW GUJARAT IS DEVELOPING SKILLED WORKFORCE

Among other world cities that could have been home to the new WHO centre, Gujarat was chosen for more than one reason. The state has taken significant strides in the direction of growth and development in the past two decades. The Gujarat government has taken praiseworthy initiatives to turn the state into a global hub for establishing businesses, world-class universities and institutions. There are many advanced Ayurveda institutes and colleges already functioning in the state of Gujarat, the new centre will boost establishment of several more.

British Prime Minister Boris Johnson, on his visit to India last month,